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Feedback Skills Key Points

Tip: Bookmark or print this overview for easy reference. See Grid on page two. Add a calendar reminder to pull feedback regularly!

Make it receivable
1a. Micro-yes

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- *Can we do a quick check-in on…?*
- *Do you have some time to talk about…?*
- *I have some thoughts on…. Can I share them with you?*

Make it receivable
1b. Behavior, not person

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Talk about what they *do*, not who they *are:*

1. *You are too sloppy.*
2. *You aren't realistic.*
3. *You were rude.*
4. *You are awesome.*

Convert it. Your [what]?

Make it receivable
1c. Data, not interpretation

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Name what a camera can capture:

1. *Your email is too sloppy.*
2. *Your proposal isn't realistic.*
3. *You always appear unfriendly.*
4. *Your summary is awesome.*

Mentally underline blur words.

Make it actionable
2a. LifeLabs Playing Cards Method™

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- ♣ **CLUB**: Negative, blurry
- ♠ **SPADE**: Negative, specific
- ♥ **HEART:** Positive, blurry
- ♦ **DIAMOND**: Positive, specific

Main point:
Vocabulary! Say to yourself, *"Oh, that was a club, let me convert it!"*

Make it actionable

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Tip: Do not pad! State negative feedback clearly.

Make it actionable
2b. Impact statement

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Specify behavior you want to repeat/diminish

I like how you gathered the data into a 1-pager and came up with an action plan.

+

Add impact statement

It helps us become more efficient as a team.

Make it balanced
3a. Balanced viewing

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So:
- Notice what people do well
- Strengthen their strengths
- Make deposits

Make it balanced
3b. Balanced feedback culture

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So that I can keep learning, I'm curious: what's one thing you liked? What's one thing I could have done 10% better?

Make it balanced
3c. Balanced dialogue

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Ask

Micro-yes

+

Tell

Data + Impact

+

Ask

Questions
- What are your thoughts?
- How do you see it?
- What can we do differently moving forward?

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Feedback Prep Grid

1. Micro-Yes • Get buy-in • Reduce mystery	2. Data point • Focus on behavior, not person • Focus on data, not interpretation • No blur words	3. Impact statement • Why does this matter? • Who is affected by it?	4. Q-step • Check if they see it the same • Joint problem solve • Agree to an action plan
EXAMPLE A: Do you have 10 minutes to talk about your last email to Jill?	**I noticed** you replied to her email three days after she sent it.	**I mention it because** she can't move forward without your reply, so it might delay her team.	What do you think our process should be moving forward?
EXAMPLE B: Can I share some thoughts with you about that meeting?	During the meeting you announced to everyone that there is a delayed schedule before letting me know.	I bring it up because we looked uncoordinated in front of our clients, which can impact their trust.	How do you see it? Can we agree to…?

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